START HERE

Your conversations.
Your AI.
Your Mac.

A calm first run, from installing Limmr to asking your AI its first question.

Start with the demo. Explore invented chats before linking WhatsApp or giving an AI access.

Choose one connection. Local clients work on this Mac. Hosted clients use optional remote access.

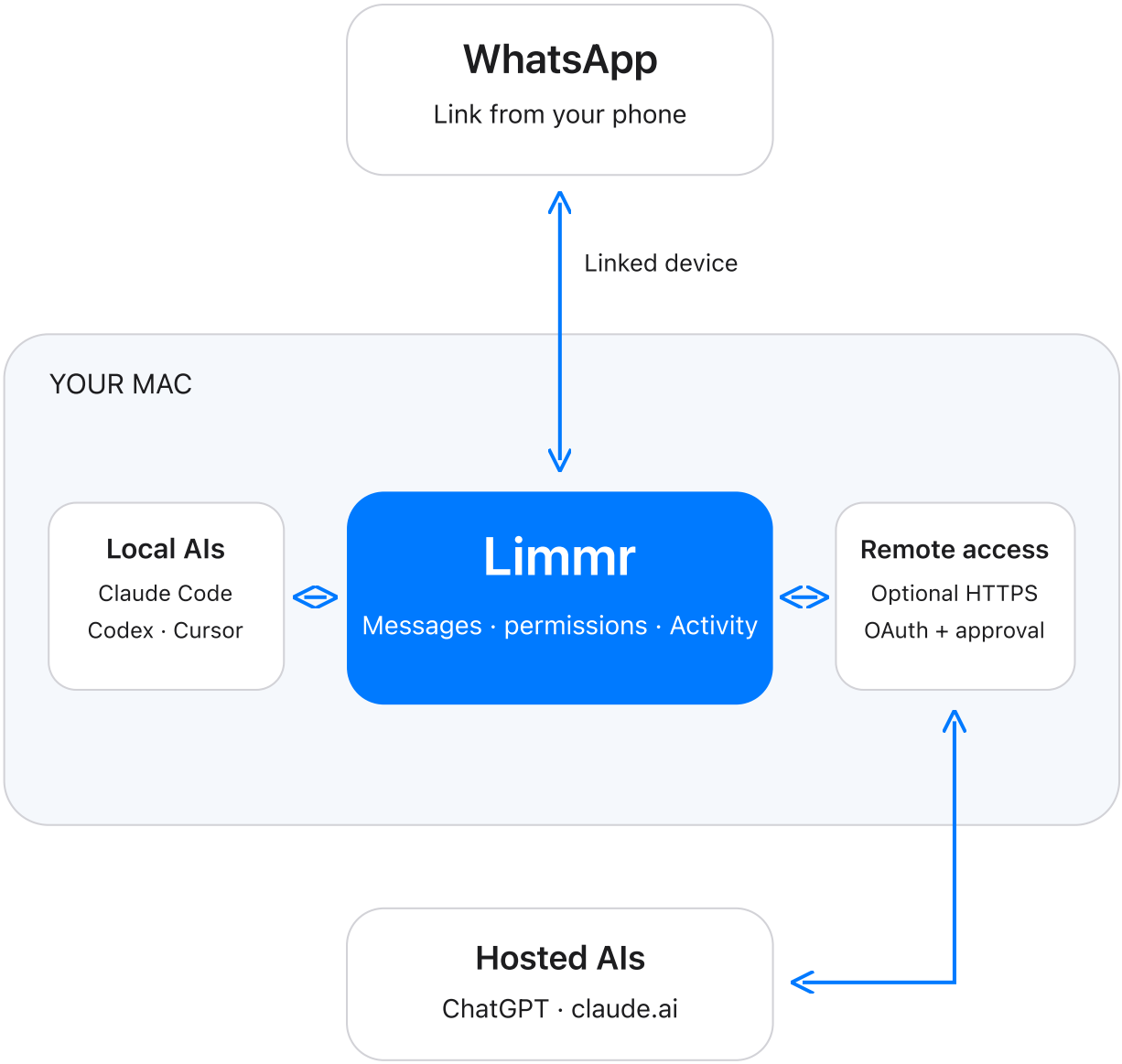
Check it worked. Ask for `whoami`, then look at Home and Activity.

For Claude Code, Codex, Cursor, ChatGPT and claude.ai.
Keep this guide beside your Mac. The screenshots use sample data only.

THE MAP

How it fits together.

Limmr is the meeting point. You choose what each AI can see.



> Messages and session keys stay on your Mac. An AI receives the data you permit and may process it at its provider. Remote access exposes the connector, not your database files.

01 / INSTALL

Install.
Then explore.

Download the DMG from this repository's GitHub Releases page when a beta is available.

01 **Drag Limmr to Applications.**
Open it from Applications after copying.

02 **Allow the self-signed beta.**
If blocked, right-click the app → Open. If needed, try opening it once, then use System Settings → Privacy & Security → Open Anyway. Confirm the macOS prompts.

03 **Allow its helper.**
When asked, allow Limmr under System Settings → General → Login Items. Return to Limmr after approving.

04 **Try demo/sample mode.**
Explore Home, People and Activity using invented chats. No phone pairing or AI credentials are needed.

Before linking

Limmr uses an unofficial WhatsApp library. Compatibility can change, and an account may be disconnected or restricted. Decide whether you want to link your account after trying the demo.

Use the release linked from the repository. Do not disable Gatekeeper to install a beta. If no DMG has been released yet, wait for the beta rather than treating source code as a finished installer.

02 / FIRST RUN

Link your phone.



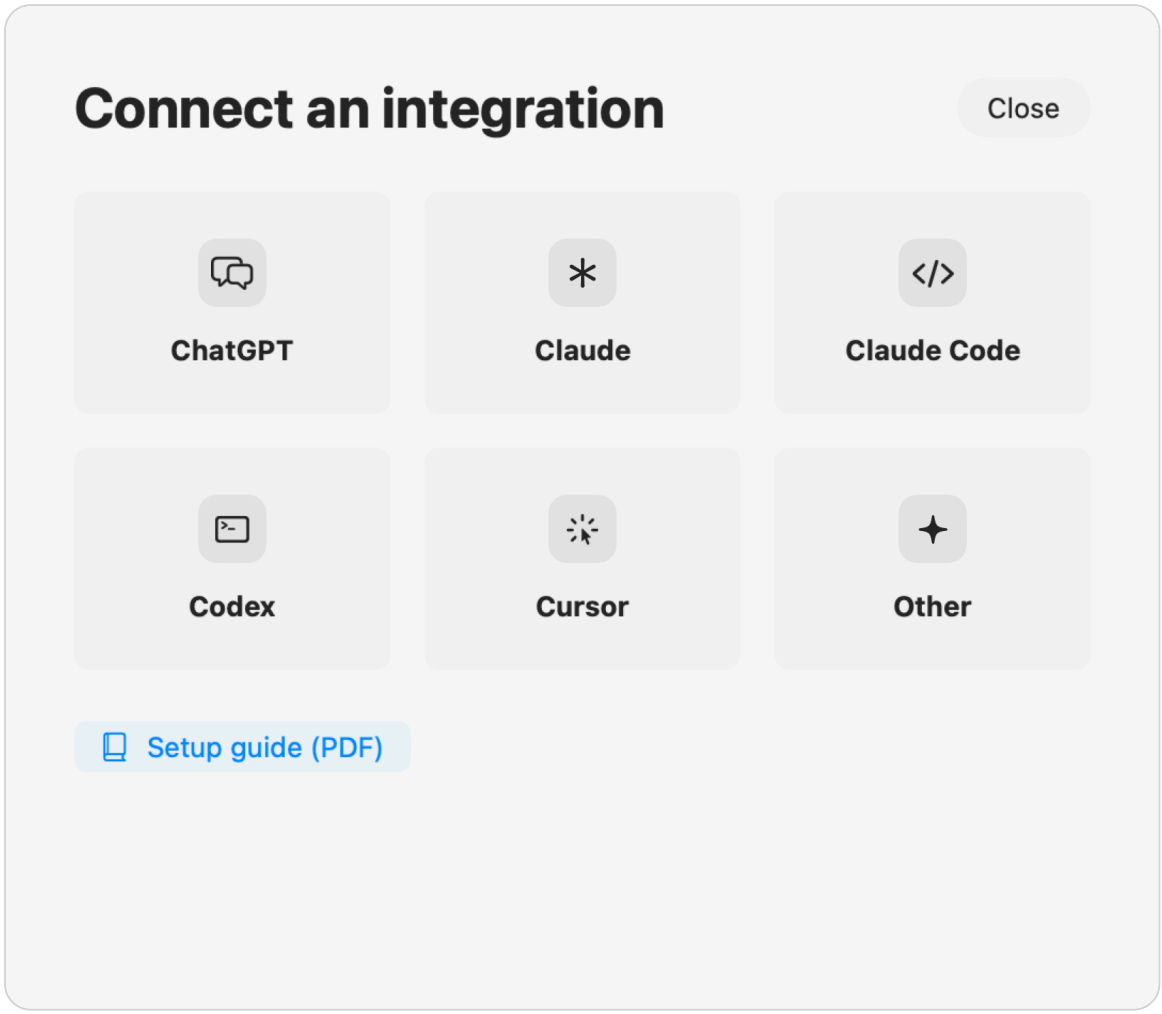
1. In WhatsApp, open Linked devices → Link a device and scan Limmr's QR code. This is a demo QR, not a live pairing request.

On iPhone, Linked devices is under WhatsApp Settings. On Android, check the overflow menu. Keep your phone nearby and allow the first history sync to finish.

> QR expired? Start a fresh code in Limmr. Logged out later? Link again. Your linked-device session and message store live on this Mac.

03 / CONNECT

Choose your AI.



2. Open Connect an AI and choose the client you use. Some app surfaces call this Connect an integration.

Same Mac · Claude Code, Codex, Cursor

Use a local connection and its own agent credential. No remote access is needed.

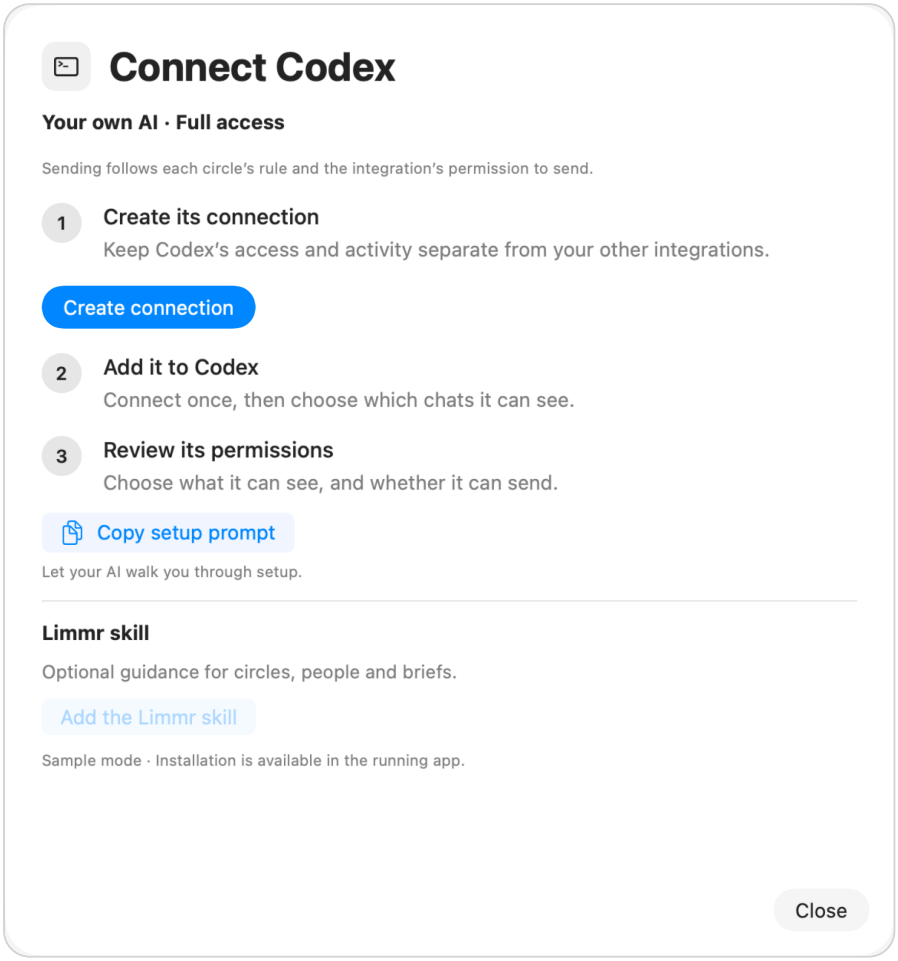
Hosted · ChatGPT, claude.ai

Enable Remote access first. A hosted AI cannot reach your Mac through localhost.

Use a separate profile for each AI or purpose. Review its visibility, duration and send permissions. You can reopen this PDF from this picker, Settings → Integrations or Help.

04 / LOCAL CLIENTS

Let your AI set it up.



3. Review access and choose Create connection. Copy setup prompt then includes this agent's private configuration; before approval it only explains how to begin.

Claude Code: use Connect or let the prompt register the server and install its skill.

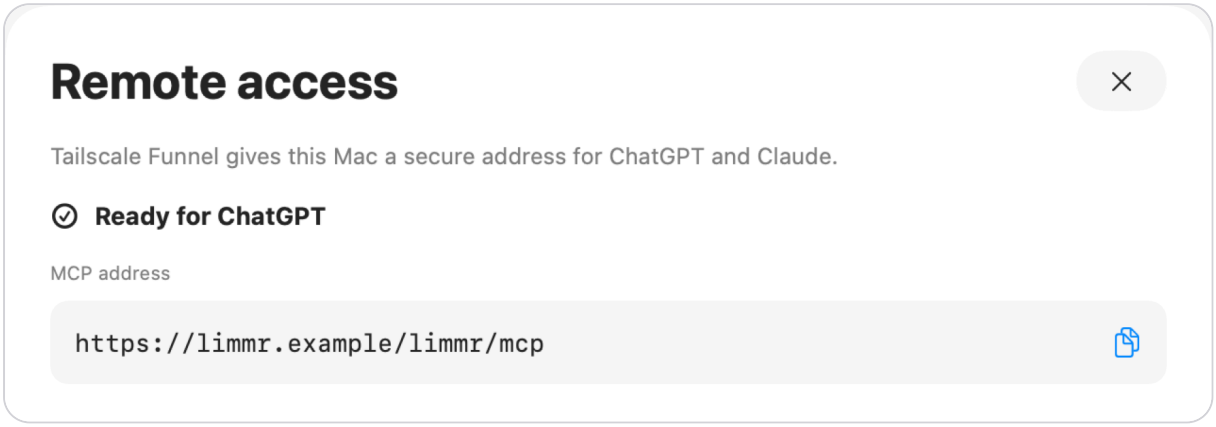
Codex: use Connect or let the prompt back up and merge its MCP configuration and install the skill.

Cursor: copy the manual JSON, or let the prompt merge mcp.json and add the bundled instructions.

Keep the approved prompt private. Reconnect your client after configuration changes. Skills guide the AI; they do not grant access. After copying: "Copied. Paste it into <client>."

05 / HOSTED CLIENTS

A route to your Mac.



4. In Settings → Remote access, set up Tailscale Funnel and wait for Ready for ChatGPT. The example address here is invented.

01 **Sign in to Tailscale.**
Install it if needed. Open Limmr → Settings → Remote access → Set up remote access.

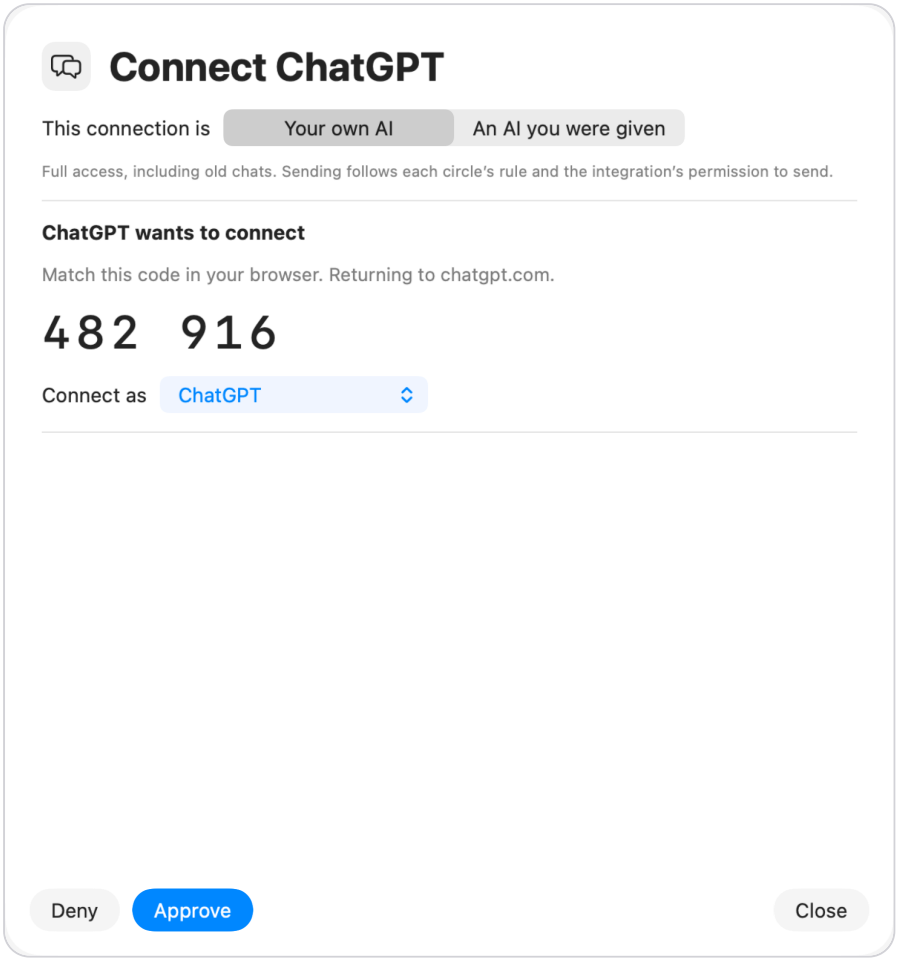
02 **Choose Tailscale Funnel.**
Let Limmr check available routes and configure the connection. Discovery can take 10–15 minutes.

03 **Wait for Ready for ChatGPT.**
Copy the MCP address ending in /mcp. Both ChatGPT and claude.ai use this route.

> Copy the public MCP address ending in /mcp. Keep this Mac awake and the helper running. Do not expose the local control port or reset unrelated tunnels.

06 / PAIR

Match. Review. Approve.



5. Start the connector in your AI client. Match its six-digit code with Limmr's review page and approve only a connection you initiated.

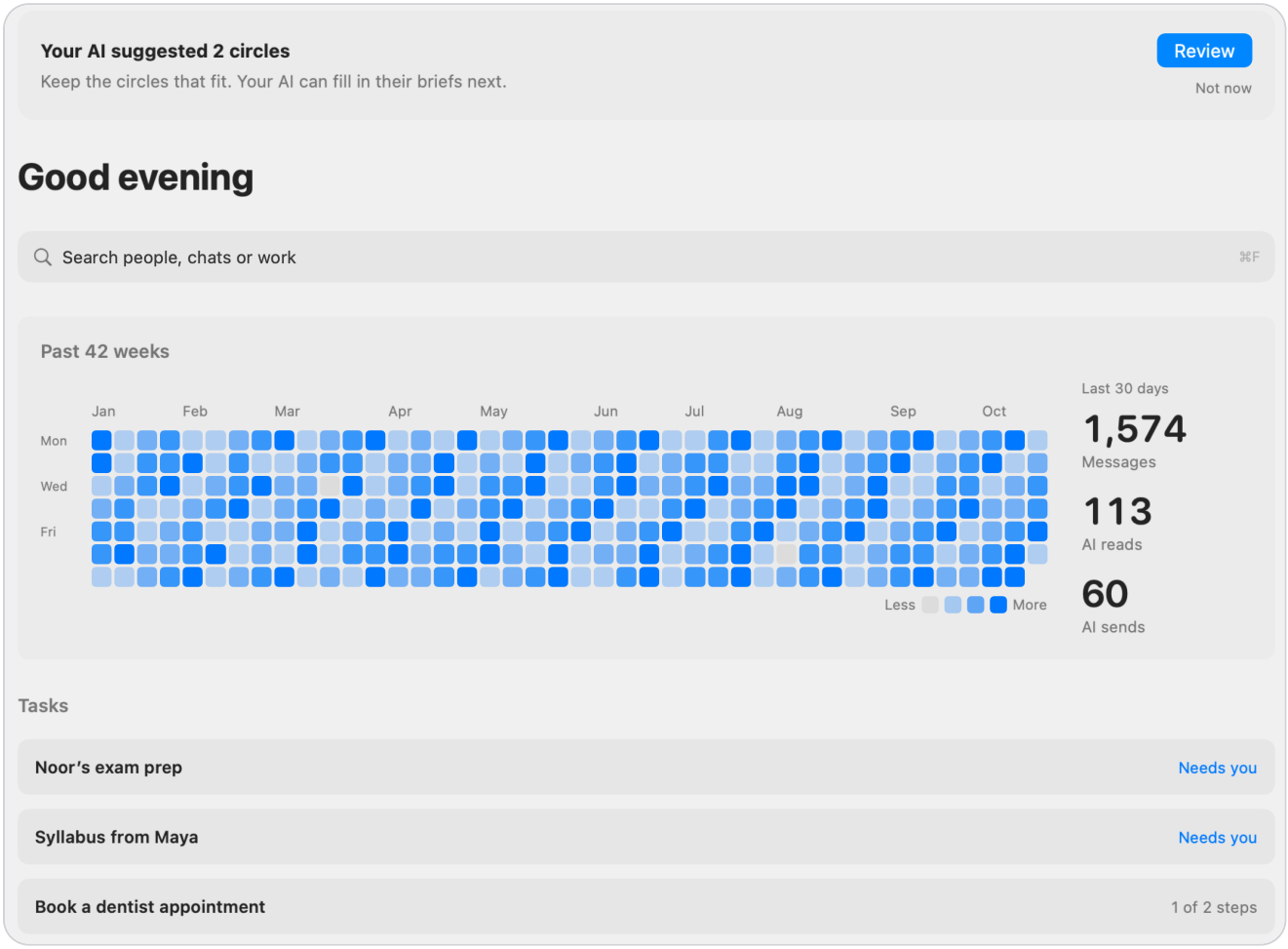
ChatGPT: open settings and add a custom connector/app with the copied MCP address and OAuth. This repo documents Apps → Advanced → Developer mode, then Create app; labels and availability need checking for your account.

claude.ai: open settings and add a custom connector. This repo documents Settings → Connectors → Add custom connector. Sign in if prompted, approve in Limmr, then return to your AI.

Review access, duration and Let it set things up. This enables people suggestions and briefs; remote sending/media stay off. Copy setup prompt walks you through these steps without a local token.

07 / VERIFY

Ask your first question.



6. After connecting, Home brings together circles, suggestions and current work. Activity records the AI's reads and changes. This screen uses invented data.

> Call **whoami** and explain my access. Then set up Limmr for me: suggest circles, explain your evidence and help me review them. Do not send messages.

Your own AI may add qualifying circles with Undo. Review membership and uncertain people details. Turn off setup/write permissions if you want read-only access.

REFERENCE / FIXES

If it gets stuck.

Start in Limmr's Health view. Check the connection you actually chose.

Connector cannot reach Limmr

Keep the Mac awake and helper running. Local client: same Mac and loopback address. Hosted client: public HTTPS MCP address, never localhost.

401 / unauthorized

The address may be reachable, but authentication has not succeeded. Check enabled state, access expiry and this agent's credential. Hosted clients need completed OAuth and matching approval. Reconnect after revocation.

Remote is not ready

Allow discovery 10–15 minutes. Check Tailscale sign-in and Funnel availability; use the wizard's Retry. Keep unrelated routes intact.

Helper is not running

Open Limmr, allow its Login Items entry and follow Health's guidance. If needed, share redacted diagnostics rather than tokens or databases.

WhatsApp logged out / QR expired

Start linking again and scan a fresh code from Linked devices. Wait for sync.

Pair page is missing or waiting

Reopen Limmr → Settings → Remote access → Review code. Retry an expired request. After approval, use "I've approved it, continue" in the browser if needed.

REFERENCE / PRIVACY

Access stays in your hands.

Give each AI the smallest access you want it to have.

What it can do

Read and search permitted chats. With write permissions, suggest circles and people details and save briefs. Use whoami and Activity to check what actually happened.

What stays hidden

Global Hidden chats stay invisible to every AI, including searches and counts. Circles, duration and revocation limit future calls. They cannot recall data already received by an AI provider.

Sending needs care

Leave sending off for a read-only beta. If enabled, circle rules apply: Never blocks sends; Confirm in chat requires confirmation or an own AI's explicit instruction from you; Free may send immediately. Requested reviews wait on Home. Limmr cannot prove a person clicked the AI client's confirmation button.

An unofficial connection

Limmr is not endorsed by WhatsApp or Meta. An unofficial library can stop working or lead to account restrictions. Demo mode lets you explore without linking an account.

Keep nearby: In the repository: docs/SETUP.md · docs/CONNECTING.md · docs/SECURITY.md

Hosted-client menu labels and account availability are based on the repository's existing documentation and still need a live release check.

REFERENCE / FILES

Send a file.

A local path or a resumable upload. The approved copy is what gets sent.

On the same computer

Give your AI an absolute path or **~/poster.pdf**. Limmr copies the file and records its hash before approval. Symlinks, credential paths and Limmr data are refused.

From a remote AI

Start upload_attachment with filename, total_size, chunk_count, chunk_index and content_base64. Keep each base64 chunk at most **1 MiB encoded** (768 KiB of file bytes). Save upload_id; resume with missing indexes. Uploads expire after one hour.

Review, then send

Choose **Review files** in Limmr. The card shows the file icon, name, size and destination. Send the completed attachment_id. Documents keep their filename and MIME; images and videos carry the caption. Check send_status for upload phases and the final receipt.

File limits

Documents: 100 MiB. Images, video and audio: 16 MiB each. Inline base64 has a separate 8 MiB decoded cap. Use chunks for larger uploads; send a link when the file exceeds its media limit.

These are conservative Limmr limits. Active uploads are bounded to four per AI and 256 MiB total. A paired send carries its copied file to the sending device.

REFERENCE / YOUR DOT

Your dot.
Your Limmr.

A dot runs its own engine. Pair it with the Mac for shared knowledge and one sending role.

Install, link, then pair

Follow docs/handoffs/DOT-ENGINE.md. Use private persistent storage and approve WhatsApp linking separately. Upgrade both engines to schema 18 / protocol 2. Start sync pair --peer on the dot; approve its code on the Mac.

Schedule and check

Run serialized sync --once every five minutes. Both engines receive WhatsApp independently. Settings → Connections and whoami show the holder and last sync. Approved queues and files follow the holder; new paired sends wait for peer acknowledgement.

If the holder is unreachable

The lease expires after 30 minutes without sync. Silence never grants takeover. Wait until expiry **plus one minute**, stop the former device and confirm **“I have stopped the previous sending device”** in owner recovery. Restore sync to reconcile queued sends.

Uncertain sends are never automatically retried and block handover. Unpairing a non-holder keeps the expiry and owner-stop fence. Imported queued requests stay quarantined; a never-paired engine works on its own.

No server-side exactly-once guarantee is made. Approved file chunks remain in private sync history; pair only trusted storage. Messages, linked-device sessions and AI credentials do not sync.